

INTELLIGENCE BRIEF / N° 216 · HOT

Mercury

Fintech · Business Banking for Startups (bank charter pending) · San Francisco (founded 2017) · Private (\$5.2B; \$200M Series D, May 2026)

Mercury, the business-banking platform used by one in three US startups, announced a \$200M Series D at a \$5.2B valuation led by TCV on 20 May 2026, three weeks after the OCC conditionally approved its own national bank. Revenue passed \$650M annualised in 2025 after ten straight profitable quarters.

74

OPPORTUNITY / 100

TIMING WINDOW

HOT

SERIES

F1

RECOMMENDED TEAM

Cadillac F1 Team

ACTION HORIZON

6-10 WKS

THE CASE

On 20 May Mercury announced a \$200M Series D at a \$5.2B valuation led by TCV, with Andreessen Horowitz, Coatue, CRV, Sapphire, Sequoia and Spark returning; CNBC puts the valuation up 49% in 14 months. Sequoia led the \$300M Series C at \$3.5B in March 2025, when Mercury reported \$500M revenue for 2024 and ten straight profitable quarters. It reached \$650M annualised revenue in Q3 2025 and serves more than 300,000 customers, one in three US startups. On 27 April the OCC granted conditional approval for Mercury Bank, N.A., headquartered in Utah under Jon Auxier, formerly CFO of SoFi Bank. This is a capital and identity inflection at once: fresh money and a company about to become a bank in its own name. Fintech has already found the grid, with Airwallex at McLaren, Revolut as Audi's title partner, Cash App at Racing Bulls and Nu at Mercedes. Mercury's customers are American founders, the audience Cadillac was built to reach, and no bank or fintech has taken the seat at the new American team.

WHY NOW

The round was announced on 20 May and the bank charter is in its organisation phase; a brand about to become Mercury Bank sets its launch budget now. Canadian GP (24 May), Monaco (7 June) and the British GP (5 July) fall inside the window; Austin and Las Vegas follow in the autumn.

PROOF POINTS — EVERY FIGURE VERIFIED TO A PRIMARY SOURCE (SEE P.2)

\$200M

\$200M Series D at a \$5.2B valuation led by TCV, with Andreessen Horowitz, Coatue, CRV, Sapphire Ventures, S...

\$300M

TCV (lead, Series D); Sequoia Capital led the \$300M Series C at \$3.5B in March 2025; Andreessen Horowitz, C...

\$650M

\$650M annualised revenue reached in Q3 2025 (company-stated); \$500M revenue in 2024 with ten straight profi...

49%

CNBC puts the valuation up 49% in 14 months.

GRID FIT — CATEGORY-WHITESPACE CHECK ACROSS THE F1 GRID (SPONSOR TABLE; 49 OF 346 PARTNER ROWS CATEGORISED)

Cadillac F1 Team	PRIME LANE	greenfield entry — partner roster being built from zero
Visa Cash App Racing Bulls	TAKEN	Cash App
Audi Revolut F1 Team	TAKEN	Revolut
TGR Haas F1 Team	TAKEN	MoneyGram

BOTTOM LINE

A \$200M round at \$5.2B, \$650M-plus of profitable revenue, and a bank charter that turns Mercury into a bank in its own name give it the budget, the motive and a launch to time a partnership to. Cadillac is the American team with no bank on the car, and Monaco and the British GP sit inside the window.

FUNDING EVENT IDENTITY INFLECTION CATEGORY PRECEDENT DISCOVERY: SCAN

WHY CADILLAC F1 TEAM

Cadillac is the first new American team since 2016 and its inaugural roster, TWG AI, Claro, Core Scientific, IFS, Jim Beam, Tenneco and Tommy Hilfiger, carries no bank, fintech or payments partner: Official Banking Partner is a clean category on the American story of the season. Its US rounds, Austin and Las Vegas, are where Mercury's founders, investors and bankers sit. The team is closing its 2027 roster in its first year, so the category is open now and unlikely to stay so.

VALUE TO CADILLAC F1 TEAM — MODE B (TECH SERVES THE TEAM OPERATION)

MODE B - halo, with concrete mechanics. No engineering workstream: the value is audience and commerce. Mercury brings 300,000 business customers, one in three US startups, as a guest list and a marketing channel; founder hospitality at Austin and Las Vegas; banking, cards and treasury for the team's US supplier base; launch-year content as Mercury becomes a bank. In return: Official Banking Partner designation, livery presence and driver access for Mercury's founders.

DEAL ARCHITECTURE

Entry as Official Banking Partner. **THREE YEARS**, 2027-2029, spanning the bank launch and a probable listing window. Estimated \$4-6M a year. Scope: sidepod or rear-wing placement, founder hospitality at Austin and Las Vegas, a Mercury Bank launch activation at the US rounds, co-branded content with the team's leadership.

PRIMARY DECISION-MAKER

Immad Akhund
CO-FOUNDER & CEO, MERCURY · **VERIFIED**

Akhund founded Mercury in 2017 with Max Tagher (CTO) and Jason Zhang (COO) and fronts every raise and the charter; a first sports partnership is his call. Path: Rachel Moncton Oatway, VP Marketing (ex-ClassPass), who reports to him, and Dan Kang, CFO since May 2025. No CMO is listed.

OPENING ANGLE

Lead with the bank launch.

“Immad, Mercury is about to become a bank in its own name, and Cadillac is the first American team in a decade with no bank on the car. Revolut and Airwallex have already taken theirs. 25 minutes before Monaco to see the numbers?”

SCORE COMPOSITION

TIMING 17 / 20 Round 20 May; charter approval 27 Apr; Monaco and Silverstone inside the window.	CAPACITY 18 / 20 \$5.2B valuation; \$650M+ annualised revenue; profitable; \$200M raised.	BRAND FIT 14 / 20 B2B fintech with a founder brand; consumer reach limited.	URGENCY 14 / 20 Bank launch is a rebrand moment; no listing signal yet.	OPS FIT 11 / 20 MODE B: audience and commerce, no engineering workstream.
---	---	---	---	---

RISKS & COUNTERS

REGULATORY TIMING Final OCC authorisation is not yet granted; a bank in its organisation phase may hold marketing until launch. **Counter:** Time the announcement to follow final authorisation; make 2027, not 2026, year one.

OWNER OVERLAP TWG Global, Cadillac's co-owner, is itself a financial-services group and may reserve the banking category. **Counter:** Ask on the first call; TWG has no startup-banking product, so the lane is complementary.

SOURCES — 22 OF 22 LOAD-BEARING CLAIMS VERIFIED

- https://www.businesswire.com/news/home/20260520511817/en/Mercury-Raises-\$200-Million-Series-D-at-\$5.2B-Valuation
- https://www.businesswire.com/news/home/20250326427283/en/Mercury-Announces-\$300-Million-Series-C-Round-at-\$3.5-Billion-Valuation
- https://www.businesswire.com/news/home/20260427949683/en/Mercury-Receives-OCC-Conditional-Approval-to-Establish-Mercury-Bank-N.A.